WiLiMan-ID

Funded by the European Union



HPAI epidemic narrative – Phase 3

Situation as of 10 April 2026

Summary of interventions implemented since 2026-02-14

The epidemic situation had markedly improved since the last communication, and it was believed that previous interventions implemented during Phase 1 and Phase 2 were effective. As a consequence, most of them have been maintained during Phase 3. They included:

- **Reactive culling**: same approach as in Phases 1 & 2; restocking of the depopulated farms is still not allowed.
- **Contact tracing**: same approach as in Phases 1 & 2
- **Zoning**: same approach than in Phases 1 & 2
- **Movement bans in the regulated zones**: same approach as in phases 1 & 2
- **Enhanced biosecurity and detectability in regulated zones**: same approach as in Phases 1 & 2
- **Pre-movement testing in the HRZ**: same approach as in Phases 1 & 2
- **Preventive culling on chicken flocks (layers and broilers) only**: same approach as in Phase 2

However, given the consistent evidence that chicken farms are contributing to the epidemic more than the duck farms, it was decided to restrict the confinement regulation to stage 2 broiler chicken farms only. The confinement measure for organic duck farms has been lifted as of 2026-02-14.

Summary of the epidemiological situation since 2026-02-14

The situation has substantially improved during Phase 3 with only 94 notified outbreaks. Consistent across this final phase, the outbreak incidence kept decreasing. The most recent case was detected on 7 April, and there have been no further reported outbreaks, suggesting that transmission has likely been interrupted. Also note that the migration period has progressively come to an end, leading to an expected reduction of the risk of exposure of poultry to infected wildlife.

Attached to this narrative, you will find a series of files that contain all epidemic data that veterinary services could collate since the start of the epidemic (including data from Phases 1 and 2 you were already given). It is expected that these sets of data are still accurate. They include:

– **outbreaks**: same format as for Phase 1 & 2.
– **movements**: same format as in Phase 1 & 2.

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- **activity**: same format as in Phase 1 & 2.
- **preventive culls**: same format as in Phase 1 & 2.

Your mission is to exploit these data and send us a report that addresses the following items:

1. A general description of the apparently-resolved epidemic, including a table describing the distribution of the outbreaks per species and production types, a timeline of the incidence and a visual representation of the spatial distribution of the outbreaks.
2. An answer with a justification to the following question: when can we start restocking the infected farms that have been depopulated, without risking a rebound of the epidemic?
3. An answer with a justification to the following question: how many outbreaks were averted (in total) thanks to the implementation of the preventive culling strategy?
4. An answer with a justification to the following question: what should have been the daily culling capacity at the end of Phase 1 to ensure (*i.e.* be 95% sure) virus eradication by the end of Phase 2?

Your report is due on 30 April 2026.

We acknowledge that we ask a lot, and that not all modelling approaches can address all the questions. Questions 1 and 2 should be addressed in priority. An investigation of questions 3 and 4 would be an immense bonus for us.

Reporting outputs

In addition to a narrative report (in .pdf) that addresses the questions above, please update the model description template you submitted at the end of Phase 2 if your modelling approach has been modified.

For any temporal prediction, please share raw simulated trajectories as a .csv file with an accompanying description (e.g. README file). If raw trajectories are not available, please share synthetic metrics of the trajectories at different time points, if possible with distributions (preferably) or at least with confidence/credible intervals, when relevant.

For spatial predictions, please share the spatial risk of the spatial units of interest at specific time points (at least at the end of the four weeks prediction) as a .csv file (preferably) or a .shp file. As for temporal predictions, please provide a description of the file.

As this is the final phase, we also would like to thank you for your time, insight, and dedication in addressing the sanitary situation on Jolly Island over these past months. Your contributions have been invaluable for strengthening our public health intelligence and improving our understanding of epidemic dynamics and control.

While this outbreak appears to be coming to an end, the broader challenges of animal health security and emerging diseases remain. Our suspicions (as well as hopes) are thus high that this will not be the last time we have the opportunity to work together!

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